TA Meeting Notes — 24 April 2026

Attendees: Will, Tijje, Haukur, Efe | **TA:** Sebastian Pusch (s.pusch@student.rug.nl)
Duration: 10:30–11:10 (40 min)

For Haukur's transcription of the meeting, see here.

Project Feedback

Verdict: Approved & within scope - TA endorsed the project as justified and useful - Fits course scope well, particularly due to novelty aspect - Good balance of challenge and feasibility

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Key Decisions & Guidance

Compression Strategy

- **Next step:** Research good starting approaches; send literature to TA for feasibility check
- **Bottleneck:** Focus compression on the model itself, not embeddings (embedding compression is secondary)
- **Scope:** Position on-edge model (with compression, quantization, pruning) as a deployment extension, not core requirement

Model Training & Evaluation

- Training process & loss function approach is sound
- **Evaluation:** Match original paper methodology, but feel free to add additional evaluation methods
- **Baseline:** FFT + SVM baseline is acceptable; optional to replicate original paper's baseline for comparison

Data Split & Class Balancing

- Question about 80/20 person-wise train/test split wasn't directly answered, but raise this for clarification

Presentation

- **Recommendation:** Use a video demo instead of live "on stage" phone demo (safer, less risk)
- Live phone demo possible but risky
- Presentation quality is not graded; focus on clear communication of results

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Timeline & Scope Management

- **Current timeline:** Ambitious but feasible if training estimates are realistic
- **Flexibility:** Can adjust deadlines after week 3–4 if needed
- **Key advice:** Identify bottlenecks early (e.g., compression challenges) and weight effort accordingly, especially for first-time implementations

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Repository & DevOps

Minimize Extra Infrastructure

- **CI/CD recommendation:** Keep simple (linters only) if pursuing; complex pipelines risk wasted effort with marginal gains
- **Deployment vs. CI:** Probably not worth setting up complex CI/CD—clarify priorities
- Don't over-engineer for extra points if it diverts focus

Easy Wins (High ROI)

- Project management (GitHub issues)
- Docker containerization
- Project management tools (boards, milestone tracking)

Action Items

- ☐ **Research & Literature** — Find best-practice compression starting approaches, send to TA
- ☐ **Clarify Training Split** — Confirm 80/20 person-wise train/test strategy with TA
- ☐ **Finalize Repo Strategy** — Decide: simple linters or skip CI/CD entirely
- ☐ **Timeline Review** — Have TA review updated timeline (with realism check on training)
- ☐ **Schedule Weekly Check-ins** — Await TA availability; aim for weekly meetings

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General Approach (TA's Meta-Advice)

1. **Identify complexities early** — compression, novel techniques, etc.
2. **Prioritize accordingly** — don't let peripherals (fancy CI, complex deployment) dominate effort
3. **Plan buffer time** — timeline can flex after week 3–4 if needed

4. **Iterate on bottlenecks first** — solve hard problems early, easy wins later

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Notes

- TA's experience: previous cohorts struggled with scope creep on infrastructure and tooling; emphasizes shipping a working model first